BIRLA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY
MESRA, RANCHI - 835 215 (INDIA)

ORDINANCE FOR Ph.D. PROGRAMME

(Approved by the Academic Council in its 108th Meeting held on 25th November 2021)

(EFFECTIVE FROM ACADEMIC SESSION MO-2021)

1. PREAMBLE

1.1 Consistent with the availability of the required infrastructure, the 'Birla Institute of Technology, Mesra, Ranchi', A Deemed to be University u/s 3 of UGC Act, 1956, shall provide facilities for research in several areas of Science, Technology, Engineering, Architecture, Pharmacy, Management, Humanities and other interdisciplinary fields leading to the award of the Degree of Doctor of Philosophy (Ph.D.).

1.2 The Ordinance lay down the procedure to be adopted for the research Programme for the Ph.D. Degree of the Institute.

1.3 Department/Center refers to an Academic Department/Center of the Institute.

1.4 Off-Campus refers to an Off-Campus of the Institute.

1.5 Academic Council refers to the Academic Council of the Institute.

1.6 A scholar is an eligible person who is enrolled at the Institute for any specific Ph.D. Programme. Prior to enrollment, this person is referred to as an applicant.

1.7 Guide/Co-Guide/External Guide is a person approved by the Academic Council for the guidance of the scholar while pursuing the Programme of research leading to Ph.D. degree of the Institute.

2. OBJECTIVES OF THE PH.D. PROGRAMME

2.1 The objectives of the Programme are to impart research training to the scholar and prepare him/her for a career in independent investigation and original research to enable him to make a significant contribution to new knowledge in his/her field and profession.

2.2 To achieve these objectives, the research Programme shall ensure:

- Current status
- Open questions
- Future scope of new knowledge and its applications
- Acquisition of fundamental and in-depth knowledge in the chosen discipline and field
- Acquisition of in-depth knowledge in the field of research
- Training in the use of research tools of the field and develop skill and capability to conduct original research

2.3 The Institute strives to fully integrate equal opportunity principles into all aspects of its activity through its decision making and planning processes.

3. ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA FOR SELECTION

3.1 Candidates with following qualifications shall be eligible for admission to the Ph.D. Programme:

a) Candidates possessing M.Tech./M.E./M.Sc.(Engg.)/M.Arch./M.Pharm./M.Plan./M.Sc./MCA/MBA or equivalent Degree with minimum 60% marks or 6.0 CGPA on a ten-point scale from a recognized University/Institute.

b) Candidates possessing B.Tech./B.E./B.Sc.(Engg.)/B.Pharm./B.Arch./B.Plan. or equivalent Degree with minimum 80% marks or 8.0 CGPA on a ten-point scale, and a valid GATE/GPAT score with minimum 80 percentile.

c) Sponsored candidates must have minimum two years of professional work experience and valid sponsorship for at least three years.

d) NOC from the Institute is mandatory for employees of the Institute.

e) Employees from other organizations shall produce NOC from their respective employers at the time of admission.

3.2 SC/ST candidates will be given 5% relaxation in marks.

4. SELECTION PROCEDURE

4.1 The Ph.D. Programme shall be open to candidates of any Nationality in true spirit of a University Education, provided that the candidate satisfies the eligibility criteria.

4.2 Admission is made twice a year (January/July) through BIT PhD Entrance Test (BIT-PET) followed by an Interview. Those with UGC-CSIR/DBT/BINC/ICMR JRF may be exempted from BIT-PET but must appear for interview.

4.3 Sponsored candidates shall be offered more weightage to experience component. Entrance examination: 40 marks (30% passing), Interview: 100 marks.

5. ENROLLMENT & SEMESTER REGISTRATION

5.1 After admission, a Roll Number will be assigned. The Department shall call a meeting of DAC to finalize:

- Field of interest of the candidate
- Guide/Co-Guide for the candidate
- Course work required for enrollment

5.2 Each scholar shall register at the beginning of every semester. Failure to register for two successive semesters results in automatic cancellation of admission.

5.3 Temporary Withdrawal is permitted only under exceptional cases (e.g., Maternity Leave, serious illness, natural calamity). Such periods will not be counted in PhD duration. Temporary withdrawal fee: Rs.10,000/- per semester.

6. GUIDE/CO-GUIDE FOR THE RESEARCH SCHOLAR

6.1 A Full-time regular faculty member holding Ph.D. Degree with at least two SCI/SCIE/SSCI/AHCI publications in the last three years can serve as Guide/Co-Guide. Supervision limits:

- Professor: maximum 8 Ph.D. scholars
- Associate Professor: maximum 6 Ph.D. scholars
- Assistant Professor: maximum 4 Ph.D. scholars

6.2 External Guide from reputed Academic/Research organizations may be approved by Academic Council. Must hold Ph.D. with at least two SCI/SCIE/SSCI/AHCI/ABDC publications in last three years.

6.3 Sponsored candidates may have an External Guide from their Sponsoring Agencies if required.

6.4 Conflict of interest should be avoided. Spouses cannot be Guide/Co-Guide/External Guide of the same scholar. Parents cannot be Guide/Co-Guide/External Guide of their children.

7. RESIDENTIAL REQUIREMENT FOR PH.D. CANDIDATE

For part-time Ph.D. candidates:

- Minimum one semester for PG degree holders
- Minimum two continuous semesters for B.Tech./B.E./B.Sc. degree holders

For full-time scholars, the minimum residential requirement is six semesters.

8. DEPARTMENTAL ACADEMIC COMMITTEE (DAC)

8.1 DAC Composition:

Position	Role
Head of Department/Center	Chairperson
Two Professors (by rotation of 2 years)	Members
Four Faculty Members (with Ph.D.) (by rotation)	Members
Two Faculty from Allied Departments (with Ph.D.)	Members
Director/In-charge of Off Campus	Member

8.2 DAC shall discuss research programme, select Guide/Co-Guide/External Guide, and assign course work. Recommendations must be submitted to Dean (PGS) within specified timeframe.

9. COURSE WORK

9.1 All Ph.D. scholars must undertake course work as prescribed by DAC within maximum of two to three semesters depending on their background.

For M.E./M.Tech./M.Pharm./M.Arch./M.Planning/M.Sc. + M.Phil holders (Maximum 2 semesters):

Course	Credits
Research Methodology	4.0
Two theory courses related to discipline	6.0
Term Paper-1: Literature review	3.0
TOTAL CREDITS	13.0

For MBA/M.Sc./MCA holders (Maximum 2 semesters):

Course	Credits
Research Methodology	4.0
Three theory courses related to discipline	9.0
Term Paper-1: Literature review	3.0
TOTAL CREDITS	16.0

For B.Tech./B.E./B.Sc. degree holders (Three semesters):

Semester-1	Credits
Research Methodology	4.0
Three theory courses related to discipline	9.0
Term Paper-1: Literature review	3.0
Total Credits (Sem-1)	16.0
Semester-2	Credits
Four theory courses related to discipline	12.0
Term Paper-2: Literature review	3.0
Total Credits (Sem-2)	15.0
Total Credits (Sem-1+Sem-2)	31.0

9.2 Each scholar needs to qualify Pre-Ph.D. papers within maximum of two attempts with at least 55% of marks or equivalent letter Grade to continue with Ph.D. Programme.

9.3 Theory courses shall be offered through classroom instructions.

9.4 The Doctoral Committee may assign additional course work if required.

10. MASSIVE OPEN ONLINE COURSES (MOOC) FOR PH.D. SCHOLARS

Ph.D. scholars are allowed to take up one MOOC (of PG level, 12-week duration only, preferably from SWAYAM portal) as per course work suggested by Doctoral Committee. Credits earned shall be directly transferred to Grade Card. Selection of courses shall be decided by Course Coordinator and approved by Dean (PGS).

11. REGISTRATION TO THE PH.D. PROGRAMME

11.1 Registration is allowed only after successful completion of course work.

11.2 Seminar presentation for registration shall be delivered in presence of DC. If satisfactory, candidate can continue. If not satisfactory, another presentation with suitable modifications must be delivered within next two months.

11.3 Ph.D. Programme duration: Minimum 6 semesters, Maximum 12 semesters. In special cases, may be extended to maximum 16 semesters (one semester at a time) as per ACAP decision.

12. PH.D. THESIS CODE FOR ERP REGISTRATION

It is mandatory for all Ph.D. scholars to register through Institute ERP Portal. After completion of Coursework including Term-Papers, scholars need Ph.D. Thesis Registration Code. The uniform code 'TH701' shall be used for all Ph.D. scholars for ERP registration.

13. DOCTORAL COMMITTEE (DC)

13.1 DC shall consist of at least six members:

Position	Role
Head of Department/Center	Chairperson
Guide and Co-Guide/External Guide	Members
Two faculty with Ph.D. (Domain & Discipline related)	Members
Two experts from Allied Departments (Ph.D.)	Members

13.2 For Off-Campus: Head of Department (Main Campus) as Chairperson. Members: Guide/Co-Guide, two faculty (one from dept., one from off-campus, with Ph.D.), two experts from allied departments with Ph.D.

13.3 DC Functions:

a) Make progressive review after enrollment and every subsequent semester
b) Forward progress report to Dean (DPGS)
c) Organize Pre-Ph.D. submission Seminar after completion of research work
d) Recommend names of 10 Examiners (5 foreign, 5 Indian) at the level of Associate Professor/Professor
e) Submit observations/recommendations of examiners to Dean (DPGS) and recommend viva voce Board

14. TRANSFER FROM FULL-TIME TO PART-TIME SCHOLAR AND VICE-VERSA

Conversion may be permitted only under unavoidable circumstances or if candidate has got job after three years. Required conditions: prescribed course work completed, fellowship withdrawn (for full-to-part), fees payable as per Institute rules.

15. COMPLIANCE REPORT

Prior to thesis submission, scholar must have:

a) Carried out research work for minimum 6 semesters after registration
b) Satisfied minimum residential requirement
c) Passed prescribed qualifying examination and course works
d) At least 2 SCI/SCIE/SSCI/AHCI indexed publications (first author)
e) At least 2 paper presentations in seminars/conferences
f) Delivered Pre-Ph.D. thesis submission seminar presentation
g) Thesis checked with Anti-plagiarism software (90% free of plagiarism) and Grammatical Software

16. ORGANIZATION OF THESIS

16.1 Thesis shall be a factual record of scholar's research work showing discovery of facts or fresh interpretation, or independent design or development of new product.

16.2 Thesis must contain:

- Brief Introduction explaining basis of thesis
- Statement indicating sources of information and originality
- Declaration as per prescribed format
- Abstract (about 500 words) with key words (about 10)
- IEEE Transactions template format
- Certificate from Guide/Co-Guide/External Guide
- Sky-blue cover page in standard format
- Text in Times New Roman font size 12, typed on one side of page only

17. EVALUATION OF THESIS

17.1 Scholar submits two soft cover copies (one for dept., one for exam dept.) and one soft copy for evaluation.

17.2 Correspondence with two examiners (one Indian, one foreign) from approved panel of 10 examiners. Each examines thesis independently and submits report to Vice-Chancellor.

17.3 If all reports unanimously favorable, DC submits recommendations for viva voce Board to Dean (DPGS).

17.4 If no unanimity and no outright rejection recommended, DC may permit resubmission after revision within 12 months. If still unsatisfactory, thesis rejected and scholar declared ineligible.

18. VIVA-VOCE BOARD AND AWARD OF THE PH.D. DEGREE

18.1 Viva voce Board comprises:

- Chairperson (DC Chairperson) - Ex-Officio
- Indian Examiner - Member
- All DC members - Members
- Dean (DPGS) - Observer

18.2 Viva voce Board conducts oral examination to test scholar's insight, comprehension, and understanding of allied fields. Report submitted to Vice Chancellor for Academic Council recommendation.

18.3 After viva voce examination completion, scholar must submit duly filled and signed student approval form to transfer copyright to University for Shodhganga repository of Inflibnet-UGC.

19. LEAVE RULES

19.1 All research scholars entitled for:

- Maximum 30 days leave per year in addition to Institute Holidays
- 10 days medical leave

19.2 Women scholars also entitled for maternity leave of 240 days (supported by medical certificate). Sanctioned by Dean (DPGS) on recommendation of Head.

19.3 No vacation in Summer is admissible.

19.4 Special leave to attend Seminars/Conferences in India/abroad with permission of Dean (DPGS) through proper channel is admissible.

19.5 Research scholars under funded projects subject to rules of funding agencies.

REGISTRAR

Birla Institute of Technology
Mesra, Ranchi-835215

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